

SPI 387: Education Policy

Week 2 Precept

Introductions!



My name is Vanessa Ntungwanayo

I am a second-year doctoral student in the
Population and Social Policy Program

I grew up in Silver Spring, MD (close to DC)

A fun fact about me is that I am the first person in
my family to be born in the United States

Please tell us about yourself!

Onto the readings...

Diagnostic:

- Labaree, *“Public Goods, Private Goods: The American Struggle for Over Educational Goals”* (1997)
- Paglayan, *Raised to Obey: The Rise and Spread of Mass Education* (2024, Ch. 1)

Prescriptive:

- Brighthouse, Ladd, Loeb, & Swift, *“Educational Goods and Values: A Framework for Decision Makers”* (2016)

Labaree, “Public Goods, Private Goods” (1997)

Three competing goals of education:

- 1) Democratic Equality: prepare citizens, promote common good.
- 2) Social Efficiency: train workers for the economy.
- 3) Social Mobility: give individuals credentials to get ahead.

Different Stakeholders have stronger interest in respective goals:

“Differences in social position give rise to different perspectives on the purposes of education. The democratic equality goal arises from the citizen, social efficiency from the taxpayer and the employer, and social mobility from the educational consumer.

The first goal expresses the politics of citizenship, the second expresses the politics of human capital, and the third expresses the politics of individual opportunity.”

Paglayan, Raised to Obey (2024, Ch. 1)

- 1) Mass schooling historically designed less to empower and more to secure social order.
- 2) Aimed to produce obedience, docility, and loyalty to the state.
- 3) Origin story of primary schooling = a tool of state-building and social control.

Discuss in pairs: When you think about your own K–12 schooling, does Paglayan or Labaree feel closest to what you actually experienced? Come up with concrete examples to share.

Brighthouse, Ladd, Loeb, & Swift, “Educational Goods and Values” (2016)

- 1) Six educational goods: economic productivity, autonomy, democratic competence, healthy relationships, treating others as equals, personal fulfillment.
- 2) Distributive principles: adequacy, equality, benefit the less advantaged.
- 3) Independent values: childhood goods, parents' interests, democracy, freedom, other goods.

Discuss as a group: Which of Brighthouse et al's substantive goals were focused on most and least heavily in your K12 education? What about in your college education?

Final Thoughts

“So if Paglayan and Labaree describe what our schools have been, and Brighthouse describes what they should aim for, what’s one change you’d want to see in K–12 or college to align the system with the goods you value most?”